

MODULE 07

Proactivity

Heartbeats &

Automations

HEARTBEAT.md, Haiku for economy, and proactive work without asking

DURATION

15 min

FORMAT

Demo + slides

KIT

2 files

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Build Your AI COO

Heartbeats: The Agent's Pulse

Heartbeats are "periodic checks" that the agent does automatically. It's like a pulse · checking if everything is okay without you asking.

What Is HEARTBEAT.md?

HEARTBEAT.md is a checklist that the agent follows with each heartbeat. It reads this file and executes the listed tasks.

Economic Model: Haiku Pro Heartbeats

MODEL

COST/HEARTBEAT

10X/DAY

30 DAYS

Opus

~\$0.10

\$1.00

\$30.00

Sonnet

~\$0.03

\$0.30

\$9.00

Haiku

~\$0.005

\$0.05

\$1.50

HEARTBEAT.md

Periodic checklist (every 4h during the day):

- [] Check urgent emails (inbox zero?)
- [] Events in the next 24-48h
- [] Projects stopped for >5 days
- [] Main business metrics

****When to speak:****

- Something urgent found · notify me
- Event <2h · notify
- Nothing new · HEARTBEAT_OK (silence)

****When to be silent:****

- 11pm-8am (silent hours)
- Nothing has changed since the last check
- Background work (organizing memory) · do it alone

MARKDOWN

Real World Economics

Using Haiku for heartbeats saves 90% of the cost. From ~\$30/month to ~\$1.50/month.

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Build Your AI COO

What to Check Automatically?

When to Speak vs. Stay Quiet

· Golden Rule

Nothing new = HEARTBEAT_OK (zero messages). The agent only speaks when there is a REASON.

When to Speak

Urgent email arrived

Event in the next 2h

Critical project stalled for >7 days

Metric out of normal (drop >20%)

Something interesting found (opportunity)

· When to Shut Up

Quiet time (11pm-8am)

Nothing has changed since last check

You are clearly busy (meeting, deep work)

Urgent Emails

Check inbox, filter by important senders or critical keywords.

1

Schedule in the Next 24-48h

Warn about upcoming meetings, deadlines, important appointments.

2

Stalled Projects

If a project has not had activity for >5 days, warn (possible stall).

3

Business Metrics

MRR, churn, CAC, active users · depending on your profile.

4

Last message <30min ago
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Build Your AI COO

Proactive Work Without Asking

The agent can do useful work in the background WITHOUT bothering you:

Real Examples from Amora

Daily Social Media Briefing

Every morning (9am), Amora sends:

Organize Memory

Compact old notes, extract lessons, update topic files.

1

Git Status of Projects

See which repos have uncommitted changes, pending tasks.

2

Update Documentation

If you changed something, the agent can update README, docs, etc.

3

Weekly Review

Every Sunday, review what happened in the week and plan the next one.

4

Daily Briefing · 16/02

Instagram:

- 3 posts yesterday (total: 1.2k likes, 45 comments)
- Post "AI COO" performed better (+320 likes)
- 12 new DMs (3 seem like opportunities)

YouTube:

- 2 videos published in the week (total: 5.3k views)
- Average engagement: 8.2% (above average)

X/Twitter:

TEXT

- 8 tweets yesterday (240 average impressions)
- Thread about OpenClaw: 1.8k views, 42 RTs

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Build Your AI COO

Configuring Heartbeats

Heartbeats are already configured in OpenClaw. You just need to customize the HEARTBEAT.md.

Advanced Option: Local Ollama (ZERO Cost)

If you want heartbeats with NO API cost, run a local model with Ollama:

MAXIMUM Savings

Local Ollama = \$0/month. Perfect for simple heartbeats (emails, calendar, status check).

Rate Limits and Budgets

Configure limits to prevent runaway automations:

Create HEARTBEAT.md

nano ~/.openclaw/workspace-seu-agente/HEARTBEAT.md

Test heartbeat manually

openclaw heartbeat

BASH

Install Ollama

curl -fsSL https://ollama.com/install.sh | sh

Download lightweight model (Llama 3.2)

ollama pull llama3.2:1b

Configure OpenClaw to use Ollama in heartbeats

openclaw config set heartbeat.model ollama:llama3.2:1b

BASH

```
{
  "heartbeat": {
    "maxPerDay": 10,
    "maxCostPerDay": 1.00,
    "pauseIfBudgetExceeded": true
  }
}
```

JSON

}

}

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Build Your AI COO

Module 7 Checkpoint

HEARTBEAT.md created (periodic checklist)

Haiku configured for heartbeats (90% savings)

2 proactive automations configured

Silent hours defined (11 PM-8 AM)

Rate limits configured (prevent runaway)

· Prompt for the Agent

Paste this prompt into your OpenClaw chat after watching Module 7:

I just watched Module 7 of the course on proactivity. I want you to become

proactive · don't just wait for me to speak. What I need you to do: 1. Configure

HEARTBEAT.md · Help me define what you should check periodically: -

Urgent emails? - Calendar events in the next 24-48h? - Stalled projects? -

Business metrics? 2. Define silent hours · when NOT to bother me

(wee hours, weekends, etc.) 3. Configure the economic model: - Use Haiku for

heartbeats (costs ~\$0.005 vs ~\$0.10 in Opus) - Advanced option: Local Ollama for

heartbeats (ZERO cost!) - Configure rate limits and budgets to prevent automation

runaway 4. Create 2 proactive automations: - A checking one (e.g. emails/calendar every

4h) - An organization one (e.g. review memory, update docs) 5. Define rules

of when to speak vs be silent: - Something urgent found · notify me - Nothing new ·

HEARTBEAT_OK (don't send me anything) - Background work (organizing memory) · does

it alone without notifying Rules: - Less is more · I don't want 10 notifications per day -

Explain the cost of each heartbeat/cron before creating - In the end, show me the

complete automation schedule Shall we make you proactive?

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NEXT MODULE

Module 8 · Multi-Agents: From Solo to Team

Module 07 · Proactivity